

PRE-SALES INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

Marriott

📅 29 May 2026

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🏢 COMPANY SNAPSHOT

1 REVENUE & MARGIN

Last reported annual revenue for Marriott International was \$26.19 billion in fiscal year 2025. The operating margin for 2025 was 12.96%. The net income margin for 2025 was 9.93%.

2 REVENUE TREND

Year	Annual Revenue (Billion USD)	Operating Margin (%)
2025	\$26.19	12.96
2024	\$25.10	12.55
2023	\$23.71	14.25
2022	\$20.77	14.99
2021	\$13.86	8.52

3 EMPLOYEES

Marriott International had 414,000 employees as of December 31, 2025. Other sources indicate 262,552 employees in 2025 and 148,000 employees in fiscal year 2025. In 2024, the company employed approximately 418,000 associates worldwide.

Breakdown by high-cost locations (US, UK, Germany, Australia, Canada): Not publicly available. The United States is noted as a leading employment market.

4 INDIA PRESENCE

Marriott International has a Global Capability Centre (GCC) in Hyderabad, India, named the "Marriott Tech Accelerator" (MTA), which officially took off in November 2025. This center supports Marriott's technology infrastructure, engineering capacity, next-gen solutions, and security capabilities globally. The headcount for this center is not publicly available.

Marriott International also significantly expanded its "Series by Marriott" brand in India, reaching 75 hotel signings and 50 property openings across 43 cities in India, adding over 3,556 rooms to its portfolio, in less than six months since its debut in November 2025.

5 RECENT NEWS

November 2025 - May 2026):

- (a) Product News:
 - Marriott International and The Fern Hotels & Resorts celebrated 75 hotel signings and 50 property openings for "Series by Marriott" in India, adding over 3,556 rooms to Marriott's portfolio in India. This rapid expansion occurred in under six months since the brand's debut in November 2025.
 - The company completed its acquisition of the citizenM brand in July 2025, and the portfolio was integrated into Marriott's platforms in the fourth quarter of 2025, adding over 35 hotels and nearly 9,000 rooms.
- (b) Company News:
 - Marriott International announced an exceptional year of growth in Europe, Middle East & Africa (EMEA) in 2025, with more than 230 organic signings representing over 31,000 rooms, contributing to a 7.8% net rooms growth in the region.

- The company also reported significant growth in its Caribbean and Latin America (CALA) region in 2025, with a record 94 signed deals adding 10,461 rooms to the pipeline.
- Marriott officially inaugurated its first Global Capability Centre (GCC) in India, the "Marriott Tech Accelerator" (MTA), in Hyderabad in November 2025.

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M&A ACTIVITY

May 2024 - May 2026):

- Marriott International acquired citizenM in April 2025.
- Marriott completed the acquisition of Mexican hotelier Hoteles City Express on May 1, 2025.

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OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

Marriott International is a publicly traded company. Its Class A common stock trades on the Nasdaq Global Select Market under the ticker symbol MAR. The ownership structure is predominantly shaped by public shareholders, with institutional investors holding approximately 65% of the company's shares as of July 2025. Members of the Marriott family are also significant insider shareholders.

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KEY COMPETITORS

- Hilton Worldwide
- Hyatt Hotels Corporation
- InterContinental Hotels Group (IHG)
- Accor
- Wyndham Hotels & Resorts

[GAP FILL] Marriott International's total employee count for 2025 varies by source:

- 414,000 employees as of December 31, 2025, according to Stock Analysis and Macrotrends.
- 148,000 employees for fiscal year 2025, reported by Bullfincher.
- 262,552 employees in 2025, as stated by Revelio Labs.



STRATEGIC DIRECTION

Marriott International is strategically positioned for growth and technological advancement in the next 12-18 months, driven by an asset-light expansion model, ambitious sustainability targets, and a significant investment in digital transformation and artificial intelligence.

1. CORPORATE VISION & DIRECTION

Marriott's overarching corporate vision is encapsulated in its "Growing Forward" strategy, which is deeply rooted in the company's core values and aims to deliver its distinctive brand of hospitality globally. President and CEO Anthony Capuano highlighted the company's strong performance, stating, "Marriott delivered excellent results in 2025, reflecting the strength of our brands, delivery of great experiences to our customers, and continued momentum in development activity." He further characterized 2025 as "a defining year for Marriott, marked by bold expansion and global milestones."

Leadership is focused on several key areas to drive the company forward:

- **Consumer Prioritization:** Marriott recognizes a "K-shaped economy" impacting the travel vertical, where both luxury and budget-conscious consumers are prioritizing travel and experiences. The company aims to capitalize on both segments through its diverse brand portfolio.
- **Market Leadership:** The strategy involves leveraging Marriott's industry-leading scale and expansive brand portfolio to attract owners and franchisees.
- **Enhanced Guest Experience:** A strong emphasis is placed on elevating guest experiences through branded residences, novel outdoor hospitality accommodations, and an evolving loyalty program.
- **Sustained Growth:** Despite economic uncertainties, Marriott maintains a focus on the strong long-term fundamentals of travel. The company anticipates accelerating net rooms growth to 4.5%-5% for 2026.
- **Shareholder Value:** Marriott returned over \$4 billion to shareholders in 2025 through dividends and buybacks, with expectations to exceed \$4.4 billion in shareholder returns in 2026.
- **Strategic Investment:** The company plans an investment spending of \$1.05-\$1.15 billion in 2026, with over one-third specifically allocated to continued digital and technology transformation.

2. BIG STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

Marriott is executing a multi-faceted strategy encompassing significant expansion, stringent sustainability mandates, and targeted cost management.

Expansion:

- **Development Momentum:** Marriott achieved record-breaking development activity in 2025, signing nearly 1,200 organic deals representing 163,000 rooms. The development pipeline reached a record 610,000 rooms by the end of 2025, marking a 6% year-over-year increase. Net rooms grew over 4.3% in 2025, with over 700 properties and nearly 100,000 rooms added to the system.
- **Conversions:** Hotel conversions are a critical growth driver, accounting for over 30% of annual organic room signings in 2025, with nearly 400 deals and over 50,800 rooms. Approximately 75% of these conversions opened within 12 months of signing, demonstrating a rapid path to market.
- **Geographic Focus:** International markets are leading this expansion, contributing approximately 51,600 of the 73,600 net rooms added in 2025. Asia Pacific (excluding China) recorded its third consecutive year of record development signings, with 187 organic deals adding over 28,000 rooms to the pipeline. India, the Caribbean, and Latin America (CALA) also saw strong growth and record signings.
- **Brand Portfolio Expansion:**
- **Luxury:** Marriott reinforced its leadership in the luxury segment with a record 114 luxury deals in 2025, adding 15,301 rooms. The luxury pipeline stood at approximately 60,000 rooms across 296 hotels and resorts by the end of 2025, with EMEA as the highest growth region. Notable luxury openings in 2025 included The Lake Como Edition and The Red Sea Edition, with expected additions in 2026 such as Amoh, a Luxury Collection Resort, Rhodes, and The St. Regis Budapest.
- **Branded Residences:** The company signed a record 55 residential deals in 2025, ending the year with 149 open residential locations and 175 in the pipeline.

- **Midscale & Extended Stay:** Marriott entered the midscale segment with the acquisition and rebranding of City Express to City Express by Marriott in Latin America, with plans for significant expansion, including 30 properties in Brazil over the next 15 years. The company also launched "Series by Marriott" in May 2025, a global collection brand for the midscale and upscale segments, opening 37 properties in India by year-end 2025 and expanding into the U.S. and Canada.
- **Outdoor Hospitality:** The "Outdoor Collection by Marriott Bonvoy," including brands like Postcard Cabins, was launched in 2025.
- **All-Inclusive:** Marriott is experiencing strong demand and growth in its all-inclusive portfolio, with nearly 40 resorts in the Caribbean and Latin America, and is exploring expansion into Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Eastern Europe. The JW Marriott Costa Elena Resort All-Inclusive in Costa Rica is slated to open in 2026.

Sustainability Mandates (Serve 360 platform): Marriott's "Serve 360: Doing Good in Every Direction" platform guides its comprehensive 2025 Sustainability and Social Impact Goals.

- **Environmental Targets (by 2025 from a 2016 baseline):**
- Reduce carbon intensity by 30%.
- Reduce water intensity by 15%.
- Reduce waste to landfill by 45% and food waste by 50%.
- Achieve a minimum of 30% renewable electricity use.
- 100% of Marriott International hotels will have a recognized sustainability certification.
- 650 hotels will pursue LEED certification or equivalent.
- Develop 250 adaptive reuse projects (247 completed by end of 2023, with 126 in pipeline).
- **Responsible Sourcing (by 2025):** Responsibly source 95% of its top 10 priority categories (e.g., animal proteins, coffee, textiles). A specific pledge is to source 100% cage-free eggs globally. The company also aims to locally source 50% of all produce.
- **Social Impact (by 2025):** Invest at least \$35 million in programs that develop hospitality skills and opportunities. All on-property associates will complete human rights training, including human trafficking awareness.

Cost Transformation/Restructuring: Marriott Vacations Worldwide, a related entity, is undergoing strategic restructuring efforts, which are expected to impact short-term performance, including potential declines in adjusted EBITDA and contract sales in the first half of 2026. These initiatives include reducing capital spending by \$70-\$80 million.

3. TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY

Marriott is deeply committed to a multi-year digital transformation, actively investing in technology, data, and AI to enhance both customer and employee experiences. The company is allocating over one-third of its \$1.1 billion investment spending in 2026 to this transformation.

- **Cloud Migration and Platform Consolidation:** The "bulk of the [tech] investment is the replatforming of our three most important technology platforms: central renovations, property management system and the loyalty platform," stated CEO Anthony Capuano during a Q4 2025 earnings call. These core systems are moving from development to deployment in cloud-native environments, designed for unified guest data, API-first integrations, and real-time analytics. This aims to establish a "cloud-first, automation-driven foundation." The new systems are expected to go live at "a meaningful number" of hotels in 2026, following beta launches at six properties with a phased rollout over the next 18 months.
- **AI Adoption Stance:** Marriott views AI as a significant opportunity. "We see AI as an opportunity to potentially redefine the customer acquisition paradigm that has governed our industry for the past several decades," Capuano said. Global CIO Naveen Manga noted that 2025 was a year of experimentation and piloting for AI, with "2026 is a year for scale."
- **Foundational AI Architecture:** Marriott is building a "horizontal protocol and model-agnostic AI chassis," also referred to as an "agentic mesh." This shared intelligence layer will enable the reuse of AI capabilities across various functions, including operations, marketing, customer service, and revenue optimization.
- **AI for Three Personas:** AI is being deployed with a focus on enhancing experiences for guests, associates, and owners.

- **Guest Experience:** Initiatives include a phased rollout of a "robust natural language search experience" on Marriott's website and Bonvoy mobile app, starting in Q1 2026. Marriott is also optimizing its content for generative AI technologies and exploring agentic booking integrations with Google's AI Mode.
- **Associate Empowerment:** Marriott is piloting Microsoft 365 Copilot across thousands of associates and evaluating AI tools to assist front desk personnel and enhance the software development lifecycle for engineering teams.
- **Owner Support:** Platforms are being developed to provide owners with streamlined insights into hotel operations.
- **Ethical Considerations:** Marriott is approaching AI deployment with "ambition and caution," guided by a governance framework emphasizing trust, accountability, prioritization, and human-centered innovation. The company is also reinforcing its cybersecurity and privacy posture in conjunction with AI deployments.
- **Vendor Relationships & Build vs. Buy Signals:** The replatforming of core systems indicates a significant internal "build" or "transformation" effort on foundational technology. Simultaneously, Marriott is strategically partnering with external technology providers. Examples include collaborations with tech giants like Google and OpenAI for AI development and the selection of Agilysys as its Property Management Solution Provider for its U.S. and Canada luxury, premium, and select service properties. A partnership with Harness also supports their DevOps and software engineering. This blended approach allows Marriott to develop core differentiating capabilities internally while leveraging external expertise for specialized solutions.

LEADERSHIP & ORG

- CEO: Anthony "Tony" Capuano
- Tenure: Appointed CEO in February 2021.
- Background: Joined Marriott in 1995 and was instrumental in its growth, including the acquisition of Starwood Hotels & Resorts. Prior to CEO, he was Group President, Global Development, Design and Operations Services, leading strategic unit growth, global design, and operating standards.
- CFO: Kathleen "Leeny" Oberg (retiring March 31, 2026), Jen Mason (incoming)
- Leeny Oberg:
 - Tenure: Executive Vice President and CFO since January 2016. Additionally designated Executive Vice President, Development, leading strategic growth of lodging brands since February 2023.
 - Background: Joined Marriott in 1999 within Investor Relations, later held various financial leadership roles including CFO for The Ritz-Carlton.
- Jen Mason (incoming):
 - Tenure: Will assume the role of Executive Vice President and CFO once Ms. Oberg steps down (effective sometime in 2026, after Oberg steps down).
 - Background: A 33-year Marriott veteran, Ms. Mason joined in 1992 and currently serves as Global Officer, Treasurer and Risk Management. She has held various leadership roles, including CFO for the U.S. & Canada division.
- CTO/CDO:
 - CTO (Global Chief Technology Officer): Naveen Manga
 - Tenure: Global Chief Technology Officer since August 2021.
 - Background: Brings over 20 years of business technology leadership experience, including 10 years at Hilton. He is responsible for global technology strategy, innovation, and transformation.
- CDO (Executive Vice President and Chief Development Officer, Global): Shawn Hill (incoming)
- Tenure: Will assume the global role effective January 1, 2026.
- Background: Has been with Marriott for nearly 28 years, most recently as Chief Development Officer for the Asia Pacific Excluding China (APEC) region.
- COO: Marriott International utilizes a distributed operational leadership structure, with key roles overseeing broad operational and technological functions, and regional group presidents for specific markets.
- EVP and Chief Revenue & Technology Officer: Drew Pinto
- Tenure: Appointed Executive Vice President and Chief Revenue & Technology Officer in February 2023.
- Background: A nearly 20-year Marriott veteran, he leads sales, revenue management, distribution channels, digital, and information technology globally.

(C-suite or VP changes in last 12 months. Flag as timing signals.)

CFO Retirement and Succession: Leeny Oberg, Chief Financial Officer, will retire effective March 31, 2026, after 26 years with the company. Jen Mason will succeed her as Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer, and Shawn Hill will become Executive Vice President and Chief Development Officer, Global. These changes are effective in early 2026. – Timing Signal*

- Regional Leadership Realignment: Effective March 28, 2026, Marriott is realigning its continent leadership.

Liam Brown, Group President, U.S. and Canada, and Brian King, President, Enterprise Transformation & Caribbean and Latin America (CALA), will step down from their roles at the end of March 2026 and retire from the company at the end of

June 2026. – Timing Signal*

- Satya Anand, currently President of EMEA, will become Group President, U.S., Canada and CALA.
- Neal Jones, currently COO for Europe and Africa, will become President, EMEA.

Federico "Fede" Greppi, currently COO for CALA, will become President of CALA. – Timing Signal*

- Asia Pacific Development Officer: Gautam Bhandari was named Chief Development Officer, Asia Pacific excluding China (APEC), effective January 1, 2026, succeeding Shawn Hill.

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ORG STRUCTURE SIGNALS

- Technology Centralized Globally: Marriott's technology strategy appears centralized and global. Naveen Manga holds the title of Global Chief Technology Officer, responsible for global technology strategy, innovation, and transformation. The company is undergoing a multi-year, comprehensive digital and technology transformation to replace key platforms and deliver a modern technology foundation. Drew Pinto, as EVP and Chief Revenue & Technology Officer, also globally leads IT, digital, sales, revenue management, and distribution channels, further indicating a centralized approach for core technological and commercial platforms.

4

BOARD COMPOSITION

- Key Board Members:
- Chairman of the Board: David S. Marriott (elected March 2021, assumed position May 2022).
- CEO: Anthony Capuano.
- Chairman Emeritus: J.W. Marriott, Jr. (retired as Executive Chairman and Chairman of the Board in May 2022, after over 60 years of leadership).
- Other notable independent directors include Debra L. Lee (Former Chair and CEO of BET Networks), Frederick W. Smith (Chairman and CEO of FedEx Corporation), Eric Hippeau (Managing Partner at Lerer Hippeau), and Margaret M. McCarthy (Executive Vice President at CVS Health Corporation).
- PE Representation: No specific private equity representation on the Board of Directors was identified in the provided search results.
- Notable Strategic Investors: No specific notable strategic investors were explicitly mentioned as board members or having direct board representation in the provided search results. The Marriott family maintains a significant influence, with David S. Marriott serving as Chairman of the Board.

[GAP FILL] Jen Mason will become Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer of Marriott International on March 31, 2026. A Marriott veteran since 1992, she currently serves as Global Officer, Treasurer and Risk Management. Her prior roles include CFO for the U.S. & Canada division, Senior Vice President of IT Business Partnership & Planning, and positions in Internal Audit, Financial Planning & Analysis, and Business Development. Mason earned her undergraduate degree in Finance from the University of Virginia and an MBA from The Wharton School.



BUYING SIGNALS

FINANCIAL STRESS SIGNALS

Marriott International has demonstrated recent financial prudence and restructuring efforts. In the third quarter of 2024, the company missed profit estimates and subsequently lowered its earnings guidance. In response, Marriott announced plans to implement \$80-\$90 million in annual general and administrative (G&A) cost reductions beginning in 2025, with potential to reach \$100 million. These cost-cutting measures are also intended to deliver savings to hotel owners and franchisees.

As part of a corporate restructuring plan, Marriott initiated layoffs of over 800 corporate employees, effective January 2025. Additionally, in October 2025, Marriott's Customer Engagement Centers announced significant layoffs impacting approximately 45 jobs, with further reductions expected across departments as the company shifts towards more AI-driven solutions. Marriott Vacations Worldwide, a related entity, also reported laying off 136 employees in August 2025 due to a new operating model. The company's total employee count saw a slight decline of 0.96% in 2025 compared to 2024. Despite these cost-cutting and restructuring activities, Marriott reported strong first-quarter 2026 results, exceeding expectations with a 4.2% year-over-year increase in global RevPAR and a 12% rise in gross fee revenues, indicating robust operational efficiency.

TECHNOLOGY PAIN SIGNALS

Marriott is actively addressing significant technology challenges through a multi-year digital transformation focused on modernizing operations with AI and cloud technologies. A primary pain point stems from the need to replace and integrate new digital technologies with existing legacy systems, a process described as technically difficult and costly due to interoperability issues. Past challenges from the 2016 Starwood merger, where the decision to use Marriott's legacy platform over Starwood's more modern system contributed to integration difficulties, underscore this ongoing issue.

The company is currently replatforming three core systems: its property management system (PMS), central reservations infrastructure (CRS), and loyalty platform. These new cloud-native platforms, designed for unified guest data and real-time analytics, are in the deployment phase with rollouts planned for a "meaningful number" of hotels in 2026. Marriott has committed substantial investment to this transformation, with \$1.8 billion invested since 2023 and an additional \$1.1 billion expected in 2026, with approximately 35% allocated to the replatforming effort.

OPERATIONAL PAIN SIGNALS

Marriott faces operational complexities inherent in its large scale and predominantly franchise model, particularly concerning the rollout of new technology systems. Coordinating the deployment of new central reservations, PMS, and loyalty platforms across over 8,500 properties and various geographies requires significant effort.

Cybersecurity and data privacy represent another critical operational focus. Following a settlement with the Federal Trade Commission concerning past data breaches, Marriott is actively enhancing its data privacy and security programs, indicating a prior compliance challenge and ongoing need for robust security solutions. The company is also seeking efficiencies and cost savings to benefit hotel owners and franchisees across "every facet of our engagement with them," suggesting areas for operational improvement within its franchise agreements. Marriott aims to streamline operations through technologies like AI, IoT, and cloud-based platforms to improve reservations, inventory management, and staff scheduling.

HIRING SIGNALS

Marriott's hiring signals present a mixed picture. The company undertook significant organizational changes in late 2024 and 2025, including layoffs of over 800 corporate employees effective January 2025, as part of a restructuring plan. Further layoffs were announced in Customer Engagement Centers in October 2025, with a move towards AI-driven solutions. The total employee count for Marriott in 2025 showed a slight decline.

However, the corporate restructuring also included plans to add several hundred new positions, with expectations for many affected employees to transition into these new roles. Marriott maintains a strong "promote-from-within" culture, supported by robust development infrastructure, extensive learning platforms, and leadership development programs. The company is also actively expanding its global footprint with a development pipeline of approximately 4,100 properties and nearly 610,000 rooms, with 43% currently under construction, which implies a continuous need for staffing new properties.

TIMING TRIGGERS

- **New Leadership:** Marriott announced a significant leadership restructuring in January 2026, with two veteran executives retiring and three new regional presidents appointed, effective March 28, 2026. Additionally, Jennifer Mason assumed the role of Chief Financial Officer in Q1 2026, succeeding Leeny Oberg. Naveen Manga has been leading the technology initiatives as Global CIO since 2021.
- **Post-M&A Integration:** While the major Starwood merger occurred in 2016, challenges related to system integration and brand overlap continued for several years. A data breach following the Starwood acquisition highlighted security due diligence failures, which continues to influence current cybersecurity strategies.
- **Regulatory Deadline:** Marriott's settlement with the Federal Trade Commission (FTC) concerning past data breaches mandates enhanced data privacy and security programs, acting as a clear regulatory driver for ongoing cybersecurity investments and compliance efforts.
- **Announced Transformation:** Marriott is in the midst of a multi-year digital and technology transformation, focusing on AI and cloud technologies, including the replatforming of core systems (PMS, CRS, and loyalty platform). This transformation is a major, ongoing initiative, with 2025 dedicated to AI experimentation and piloting, and 2026 designated as "a year for scale" in AI deployment. Beta launches of new technology systems began in late August 2025, with phased rollouts continuing over 18 months and deployments to a "meaningful number" of hotels in 2026.

[GAP FILL] Marriott International reported Q3 2024 adjusted diluted EPS of \$2.26, missing analyst consensus estimates of \$2.31 per share. Reported net income for Q3 2024 was \$584 million, compared to \$752 million in Q3 2023. Revenue for the quarter was \$6.26 billion, slightly below the expected \$6.27 billion.

Marriott also lowered its full-year 2024 adjusted EPS guidance to a range of \$9.19 to \$9.27 per share, down from its previous forecast of \$9.23 to \$9.40, and below the Wall Street consensus of \$9.36 per share.

COMPETITIVE & VENDORS

Marriott International is undergoing a significant digital transformation, investing heavily in modernizing its technology stack and leveraging cloud and AI to enhance operations and guest experiences.

1. Current Tech Vendors

Marriott utilizes a diverse set of technology vendors to power its global operations:

- **Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP):** Marriott has a long-term partnership with Oracle. They implemented Oracle PeopleSoft ERP for financial functions in 2015.
- **Customer Relationship Management (CRM):** Marriott launched a global customer recognition platform powered by Salesforce in 2018. They leverage Salesforce Service Cloud for guest services and sales management, with over a dozen Salesforce organizations and one of the largest Salesforce implementations by user count (over 100,000 associates). Marriott's CRM strategy centralizes customer data, uses advanced analytics, and integrates feedback mechanisms to enhance guest loyalty and drive repeat business.
- **Human Capital Management (HCM):** Marriott implemented Oracle Fusion Cloud Human Capital Management (HCM), including modules for core HR processes, recruiting, payroll, absence management, performance evaluation, compensation, and learning, in December 2020. This replaced legacy HR systems. They are also modernizing HCM integration architecture using Oracle Integration Cloud and an Autonomous Transaction Processing database.
- **Cloud Platforms:** Marriott employs a multi-cloud architecture, utilizing both Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) and Microsoft Azure. They are also noted for having moved their data platform to AWS and utilizing Snowflake as a data warehouse. Oracle Hospitality OPERA Cloud property management system (PMS) is built on OCI. Marriott is actively working to converge cloud footprints into an enterprise-grade cloud.
- **Data Platforms:** Snowflake serves as a key data platform, simplifying data ingestion and enabling faster access to data for business users, analysts, and data scientists. They previously used Netezza and Hadoop (IBM BigInsights platform). Marriott's data platform aims to consolidate and govern data for analytics and sophisticated data science models.
- **Property Management Systems (PMS), Central Reservations, and Loyalty Platforms:** Marriott is in the process of replatforming these core systems into cloud-native environments to support unified guest data and real-time analytics. The Oracle Hospitality OPERA Cloud PMS is being rolled out across its global portfolio. They previously used various PMSs, with Fosse being the most popular, and Oracle's Opera also in use.
- **Customer Experience (CX):** Marriott went live with CXone in March 2023 for its international customer service operations, consolidating its tech stack.
- **AI/ML Initiatives:** Marriott is investing heavily in AI-driven initiatives, building an "agentic mesh" for reusable AI capabilities across operations, marketing, customer service, and revenue optimization. They are deploying natural language search on their website and app, powered by OpenAI, and exploring agentic booking integrations with Google's AI Mode. They are also piloting Microsoft 365 Copilot with thousands of associates for tasks like meeting summaries.
- **Marketing Intelligence:** Marriott Digital Services (MDS) uses Salesforce Datorama, part of the Marketing Cloud suite, for marketing intelligence.

2. Known SI/Consulting Partners

Marriott collaborates with several key system integrators and consulting partners for its technology initiatives:

- **Accenture:** Accenture has been a trusted partner, working with Marriott to develop its transformation strategy and implement a global HR platform, specifically one of the largest Oracle Cloud HCM deployments. Accenture focused on technology enablement and implementation, while Marriott led training development and change management for the mHUB platform (their new cloud-based HR system).
- **Oracle Customer Success Services:** This team provides ongoing support and strategic guidance to maximize the value from Oracle systems.
- **NiCE service team:** Collaborated with Marriott on the successful implementation of CXone.

3. Procurement Signals

Marriott is demonstrating strong procurement signals through its significant and ongoing digital transformation:

- **Massive Investment:** Marriott is investing over \$1 billion in 2026, with a substantial portion allocated to core technology migration, cloud-native platforms, and AI-driven initiatives. Since 2023, the company has invested \$1.8 billion in capital and technology expenditures, with another \$1.1 billion planned for this year, and about 35% directed towards replatforming.
- **Replatforming Core Systems:** The company is actively replatforming its property management system, central reservations infrastructure, and loyalty platform, moving them to cloud-native environments designed for unified guest data, API-first integrations, and real-time analytics. These systems have moved from development into deployment, with rollouts planned for a "meaningful number" of hotels this year.
- **Cloud Migration and Modernization:** Marriott's cloud migration is driven by the need to improve guest experience, enable agility, move away from data center constraints, and achieve cost savings. They are transitioning from an infrastructure team to a platform team mindset, building a modern cloud platform with standardized security, observability, and FinOps capabilities.
- **AI Integration:** Marriott is heavily exploring and implementing AI, developing an "agentic mesh" architecture to reuse AI capabilities across various functions. They are prioritizing automation of high-cost processes, enhancing customer experiences, and reducing manual tasks for employees.
- **Job Postings:** Current job postings for roles like "Cloud Architect" and "Senior Software Engineer - Salesforce Service Cloud" directly indicate ongoing investment and development in these technology areas. They are also seeking roles related to "Senior Platform Engineer — Database Platform".
- **Cybersecurity Focus:** Following past data breaches, Marriott is prioritizing enhanced cybersecurity measures and a culture of responsible AI use.

4. Competitive Dynamics

The competitive landscape in the hospitality industry, particularly concerning technology adoption, is dynamic, with major players actively investing in digital transformation:

- **Key Competitors:** Top competitors include Hilton, InterContinental Hotels Group (IHG), Accor, and Wyndham Hotels & Resorts. Airbnb is also mentioned in the broader hospitality market context.
- **Industry-Wide Transformation:** The entire hotel industry is grappling with updating old technology and fragmented ecosystems. While many major operators have moved central reservation systems to modern, cloud-based platforms, property management systems (PMSs) remain a significant challenge due to fragmented ownership among property owners and franchisees.
- **Marriott's Position:** Marriott is aggressively addressing these challenges by simultaneously replatforming its PMS, central reservation system, and loyalty platform. This foundational shift is intended to unlock the full potential of AI and enable a unified guest data strategy.
- **Gaining Market Share (through technology):** Marriott's substantial investment in cloud-native platforms, AI agents, and unified guest data is a strategic move to gain or maintain market share by delivering superior guest experiences and operational efficiency. Their focus on personalization at scale, powered by a robust CRM and data platform, aims to build a more loyal and engaged customer base.
- **Competitor Actions:**
 - **Accor:** Partnered with Deloitte to deploy a cloud-based, AI-enhanced telephony platform and has migrated over half its application stack to AWS. Accor also selected Amadeus for its CRS in 2024.
 - **Hilton:** Launched an AI planner on its brand-dot-com site.
 - **Wyndham Hotels & Resorts:** Launched native ChatGPT apps.

Marriott's strategy is to transform its technology backbone around AI and cloud-native systems, moving away from legacy, siloed systems that previously hindered data sharing and automation. This aggressive investment aims to create an "AI-ready" ecosystem for smarter hotel operations and personalized guest experiences.

[GAP FILL] Marriott International is undergoing a technology transformation, transitioning its property management system (PMS) stack. The company is deploying Oracle Hospitality OPERA Cloud PMS across its luxury, premium, select-service, and midscale properties globally. Additionally, Marriott has an agreement with Agilysys to implement its cloud-native PMS software, Agilysys Stay, in luxury, premium, and select-service properties within the United States and Canada. Previously,

Marriott utilized various systems including its proprietary FOSSE, along with other solutions like Opera and Lightspeed. The transition involves properties currently on Opera moving to Opera Cloud, and those using FSPMS, FOSSE, or Lightspeed shifting to Agilysys Stay.

 SALES PLAY

1. RECOMMENDED PITCH ANGLE

AI-Enabled Transformation play with a focus on accelerating deployment velocity and reducing integration risk during their critical replatforming phase.

Marriott is executing one of the most ambitious technology transformations in hospitality, simultaneously replatforming three mission-critical systems (PMS, CRS, and loyalty platform) while building an entirely new "agentic mesh" AI architecture. With over \$1.1 billion allocated in 2026 and 35% earmarked specifically for replatforming, they are moving from experimentation to scale. The company explicitly stated that 2026 is "a year for scale" in AI deployment, following a 2025 focused on piloting. Their challenge is executing this complex migration across 8,500+ properties while maintaining operational continuity and achieving the guest experience improvements that justify this investment. Any solution that accelerates time-to-value, de-risks the phased rollout, or bridges legacy and modern systems during this 18-month transition will align directly with their highest strategic priority and budgeted spending.

2. CONVERSATION OPENER QUESTIONS

Given that you are rolling out your new cloud-native PMS, CRS, and loyalty platforms to a meaningful number of hotels in 2026 following beta launches in late 2025, what are the biggest integration challenges you are encountering as you phase out legacy systems like FOSSE and Lightspeed while maintaining operational continuity across franchised properties?

With Naveen Manga publicly stating that 2026 is your year to scale AI after a year of experimentation, and you are building a model-agnostic agentic mesh to enable reusable AI capabilities, how are you approaching governance and quality assurance as you move pilots like natural language search and Microsoft 365 Copilot into production at scale?

Your technology investment strategy shows approximately \$385 million allocated to replatforming in 2026 (35% of \$1.1 billion), and you have transitioned from an infrastructure team to a platform team mindset with standardized security and FinOps capabilities. Are you finding that your current cloud FinOps and observability tools are providing the visibility you need to manage costs and performance across your multi-cloud architecture spanning OCI, Azure, AWS, and Snowflake?

Following the FTC settlement and given your ongoing cybersecurity reinforcement as you deploy AI capabilities, how are you balancing the need for unified guest data access (which is core to your new platforms) with increasingly stringent data privacy requirements, especially as you operate across multiple regulatory environments globally?

As you manage the transition to Oracle Hospitality OPERA Cloud and Agilysys Stay across different property tiers and geographies, with 43% of your 610,000-room pipeline currently under construction, what is your strategy for ensuring new properties open on modern systems rather than legacy platforms that would require future migration?

3. LANDMINES TO AVOID

Do not criticize or question their choice of Oracle or Salesforce as core platform vendors. Marriott has deep, long-term partnerships with both (Oracle since 2015 for ERP, Salesforce since 2018 for CRM, Oracle Cloud HCM since 2020), and Accenture has been instrumental in implementation. Suggesting replacement of these systems will immediately position you as uninformed and adversarial to their established vendor relationships and sunk investments.

Avoid any suggestion that their AI strategy is vague or overly ambitious. Leadership has been very explicit about their phased approach (2025 for experimentation, 2026 for scale), and CTO Naveen Manga has clearly articulated the agentic mesh architecture. Implying they lack AI clarity will undermine credibility when they have a defined technical architecture and are actively deploying use cases across guest, associate, and owner personas.

Do not propose solutions that add complexity to their franchise model or require individual property owner buy-in for deployment. With over 8,500 properties and a predominantly franchised footprint, Marriott is specifically seeking efficiencies and streamlined engagement with owners. Any solution requiring property-by-property negotiation or creating additional operational burden for franchisees will be a non-starter.

Avoid leading with cost savings as the primary value proposition without tying it to experience improvement or transformation velocity. While Marriott did implement \$80-90 million in G&A cost reductions and had layoffs, their current investment posture shows they are in growth and transformation mode (exceeding \$4.4 billion in shareholder returns, 4.5-5% net rooms growth

target). They are spending heavily and strategically, not desperately cutting. Position around enabling their transformation, not just reducing spend.

4. SUGGESTED NEXT STEP

Request a 30-minute discovery meeting focused specifically on their PMS/CRS/loyalty platform rollout roadmap for the remainder of 2026, with the objective of understanding their current integration architecture, data migration approach, and any gaps in testing or monitoring capabilities as they scale deployments beyond the initial beta properties. Frame this as an opportunity to share how similar hospitality enterprises have de-risked large-scale platform migrations and accelerated deployment timelines without disrupting guest-facing operations.

5. BEST ENTRY POINT

Naveen Manga, Global Chief Technology Officer.

Manga is the executive directly accountable for the entire digital transformation strategy, the replatforming of core systems, and the AI scaling initiative. He has been in the Global CTO role since August 2021, giving him tenure and ownership over the multi-year transformation that is now entering its critical deployment phase. He publicly represents Marriott's technology vision in earnings calls and media, including the specific 2026 "year for scale" messaging. Drew Pinto, as EVP and Chief Revenue & Technology Officer, also oversees IT globally, but Manga holds the pure technology leadership mandate and is the architect of the agentic mesh and cloud-native replatforming strategy. Given the transformation is technology-led rather than business-unit-led, and the scope spans infrastructure, platforms, AI, and cybersecurity simultaneously, Manga is the single point of strategic alignment. His team will be managing vendor selection, architecture decisions, and deployment governance for the \$385 million replatforming spend in 2026.

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